

# Human-Centered Robot Learning and Interaction

HumanRLI 2026

Toward Reliable and Scalable Autonomy in Human Environments

November 12, 2026 Austin, Texas, USA In-person

Robot learning has made rapid progress on dexterous manipulation, locomotion, navigation, and increasingly general vision-language-action models. Yet real-world deployment means operating **in human environments and around humans** — homes, hospitals, offices, warehouses, public spaces — where people are not only end-users but also **collaborators, supervisors, demonstrators, and bystanders**. This workshop asks how we translate lab-scale demonstrations into systems **reliable enough to be trusted** and **scalable enough to deploy** across diverse users, tasks, and settings.

## • Call for Papers — Representative Topics

- 1 Learning from Human Data**  
Scalable interaction data · demonstrations, corrections, preferences · continual learning from feedback · privacy, consent, effort
- 2 Human-Aware Foundation Models**  
Grounding VLA models in contact and social norms · human attention, intent, mental states · personalization and preference alignment
- 3 Reliability, Safety, Evaluation**  
Benchmarks beyond task success · robustness to clutter, interruptions, novice users · failure detection, recovery, graceful handover
- 4 Long-Horizon Interaction**  
Turn-taking, intent inference, interaction repair · multi-session memory · field studies in homes, hospitals, warehouses

## • Important Dates

Submissions Open **Sep 16, 2026**Deadline **Oct 9, 2026**Notification **TBD**Camera Ready **TBD**Workshop Day **Nov 12, 2026**

Deadline 11:59 PM Anywhere on Earth (AoE)

## Invited Speakers



**Aude Billard**  
EPFL

Learning from demonstration; safe physical interaction



**Harold Soh**  
NUS

Trust-aware HRI; tactile perception; learning from feedback



**Andreea Bobu**  
MIT

Representations of human intent; preference alignment



**Moritz Bächer**

Disney Research Zurich  
Computational design; expressive robotic characters



**Jakob Thumm**

Stanford University  
Provably safe human-robot collaboration; personalization

## Program (Half Day)

**0:00** Opening & live challenge poll

**2:00** Poster & live-demo session

**3:15** Contributed spotlight talks

**0:15** Invited talks — four 20-min talks + Q&A

**2:40** Fishbowl discussion

**3:45** Closing synthesis & roadmap

## Organizing Committee



**Jiachen Li**  
Georgia Tech



**Jing Liang**  
Stanford



**Yao Feng**  
Tsinghua



**Zehao Wang**  
Georgia Tech



**Zhangchen Ye**  
Tsinghua



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CMU



**Qi Chen**  
Toyota InfoTech



**Yongkang Liu**  
Toyota InfoTech



**Akin Sisbot**  
Toyota InfoTech



**Julian Nubert**  
Flexion Robotics

Submit on OpenReview · Non-archival · Double-blind

Up to 8 pages in total, including references and appendices · CoRL template  
[openreview.net/group?id=robot-learning.org/CoRL/2026/Workshop/HumanRLI](https://openreview.net/group?id=robot-learning.org/CoRL/2026/Workshop/HumanRLI)

**Submit →**  
by Oct 9, 2026